EK-14 Glossary, FAQ and Edge Cases

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1. Document metadata

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Purpose and scope: define terms, answer common questions and specify handling of edge cases in proposal evaluation.

2. Executive summary

Eleven glossary terms, six frequently asked questions and seven edge cases such as a single proposal, all proposals ineligible, zero weights and team proposals.

3. Glossary

Term	Definition
Adjusted price	Proposed price plus the estimated cost of required work the proposal excludes
Capacity	Committed hours per week x proposed weeks
Hard constraint	A limit whose violation makes a proposal ineligible
Preference	A wish that affects the score only
Direct evidence	A verified project artifact at or above the required level
Indirect evidence	A verified related skill
Unsupported claim	A skill stated without an artifact
Reference duration	Typical duration for the scope (illustrative)
Proposal completeness	Items passed of the 8-item checklist (EVA-007)
Hold pending evidence	Mandatory skill lacks direct evidence; not a rejection
Shrinkage	Pulling a small-sample average toward a neutral prior

4. Frequently asked questions

Question	Answer
Can a proposal above the preferred budget win?	Yes. It only loses budget points; above the hard limit it is ineligible.
Does the cheapest proposal score highest?	No. A price below the preferred maximum earns 100, and very low prices are flagged.
Is a freelancer with no reviews penalized?	No. The reviews criterion is not scored and weights are renormalized.
Does faster delivery score higher?	No. Any duration within the deadline scores 100; unsupported speed is flagged.
What if two proposals tie?	Show both, state the difference is within uncertainty and compare on flags and criteria.
Who calculates the score?	Deterministic code; the language model only explains.

5. Edge cases

Situation	Handling
Only one proposal	Score it and explain; do not describe it as the best of many.
All proposals ineligible	Report why for each and suggest relaxing a hard constraint.
Weights sum to zero	Reject the weights with a clear message.
Missing job effort estimate	Skip capacity and reference checks; state that feasibility was not checked.
Team proposal with several freelancers	Evaluate each person's evidence separately and combine capacity with the overhead rule (EK-10).
Conflicting profile and case study	Prefer the case study and report the conflict.
Currency differs from the job	Convert with a stated rate and date or mark budget comparison low confidence.

6. Evidence requirements and uncertainty

When a question is not covered by these documents the assistant says so and does not improvise rules.

7. Summary of key findings

- Edge cases have defined handling.
- The cheapest bid does not automatically win.
- Uncovered questions are answered with 'not covered'.

8. Keywords and alternative terminology

glossary; FAQ; edge cases; terminology; definitions; ties; single proposal